

Answer Key

Grammar

Reported Speech — Statements & Tense Back-shift

When we report a statement, the reporting verb (said, told) is usually in the past, so the tense of the original statement moves one step back into the past: present simple → past simple, present continuous → past continuous, past simple → past perfect, will → would, can → could.

Bir ifadeyi aktarırken, aktaran fiil (said, told) genellikle geçmiş zamanda olduğu için, orijinal cümlelerin zamanı bir adım geriye kayar: geniş zaman → geçmiş zaman, şimdiki zaman → geçmiş zamanın hikayesi, geçmiş zaman → miş'li geçmiş (had + V3), will → would, can → could.

When? We use reported speech to tell someone what another person said, without quoting their exact words — very common in sports news reports and interview summaries.

Reported speech, başka birinin söylediklerini onun tam kelimelerini alıntılamadan aktarmak için kullanılır — spor haberlerinde ve röportaj özetlerinde çok sık görülür.

Positive

- Subject + said/told (object) + (that) + clause with back-shifted tense

Negative

- Subject + said + (that) + subject + did not/had not + verb

Question

- Not used for statements — see reporting questions in a later theme.

Short answers

- He said he was tired.
- She told me she had trained hard.

Common mistakes

- ~~He said he is tired.~~ → **He said he was tired.**
- ~~She told that she won the race.~~ → **She said that she had won the race.**

1. "I am ready for the match," she said. → She said she _____ ready for the match. **(was)**
am → was

2. "We trained all summer," the team said. → The team said they _____ all summer. **(had trained)**
trained → had trained

3. "I will score a goal," the striker said. Reported speech:

- a. The striker said he will score a goal.
- b. The striker said he would score a goal. ✓
- c. The striker said he scored a goal.
- d. The striker says he would score a goal.

will back-shifts to would.

4. "I can't play today," he said. → He said he can't play today. — *True / False* **(Incorrect — He said he could not play that day.)**

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can't must back-shift to could not, and 'today' changes to 'that day'.

5. "The referee made a mistake," the coach said. (*The coach said...*) **The coach said (that) the referee had made a mistake.**

6. Put the words in order: he / said / tired / was / the coach

The coach said he was tired.

7. "I am watching the match," she said. → She said she _____ the match. **(was watching)**

am watching → was watching

8. "We have won three championships," the captain said proudly. (*The captain said...*) **The captain said proudly (that) they had won three championships.**

9. "I could not train yesterday because of my injury," the athlete said. Reported speech:

- a. The athlete said she could not train the day before because of her injury. ✓
- b. The athlete said she cannot train yesterday because of her injury.
- c. The athlete said she could not train yesterday because of her injury.
- d. The athlete says she could not train the day before because of her injury.

'could not' stays the same (it is already a past modal), and 'yesterday' changes to 'the day before'.

Reported Speech — Pronouns, Time Expressions & Reporting Verbs

In reported speech, pronouns change to match the reporter's point of view (I → he/she, my → his/her, we → they), and time/place expressions shift away from the moment of speaking (today → that day, tomorrow → the next day, yesterday → the day before, here → there). We also choose the reporting verb carefully: 'say' does not take a personal object (say something), while 'tell' needs one (tell someone something).

Reported speech'te zamirler, aktaran kişinin bakış açısına göre değişir (I → he/she, my → his/her, we → they); zaman/yer ifadeleri de konuşma anından uzaklaşacak şekilde değişir (today → that day, tomorrow → the next day, yesterday → the day before, here → there). Ayrıca aktaran fiil dikkatle seçilir: 'say' kişisel bir nesne almaz (say something), 'tell' ise bir nesneye ihtiyaç duyar (tell someone something).

When? We use these changes whenever the reporting happens at a different time or place from the original statement — for example, a journalist reporting a coach's comments a day after they were made.

Bu değişiklikler, aktarma işlemi orijinal ifadenin söylendiği zamandan veya yerden farklı bir zaman/yerde yapıldığında kullanılır — örneğin bir gazetecinin, bir antrenörün yorumlarını ertesi gün aktarması gibi.

Positive

- Subject + said/told (object) + (that) + clause with adjusted pronouns & time/place words

Negative

- Subject + said/told + (that) + subject + did not/had not + verb (adjusted pronouns & time/place words)

Question

- Not covered in this point — see statement patterns above.

Short answers

- He told me he was training then.
- They said they had played there.

Common mistakes

- ~~She said me she was tired.~~ → **She told me she was tired.**

- ~~He said he will play here tomorrow.~~ → **He said he would play there the next day.**

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1. "I feel great," the athlete said. → The athlete said _____ felt great. **(she)**

'I' becomes 'she' from the reporter's point of view.

2. "We will train tomorrow," the coach said. → The coach said they would train _____. **(the next day)**

'tomorrow' becomes 'the next day'.

3. "My team played well here," the captain said. Reported speech:

- a. The captain said his team had played well here.
- b. The captain said his team had played well there. ✓
- c. The captain said my team had played well there.
- d. The captain said his team plays well there.

'my' → 'his', and 'here' → 'there'.

4. "I saw the match yesterday," she told me. → She told me she had seen the match yesterday. — True / False
(Incorrect — She told me she had seen the match the day before.)

'yesterday' must change to 'the day before' in reported speech.

5. "I will meet you here tomorrow," the reporter said. *(The reporter said...)* **The reporter said (that) he/she would meet me there the next day.**

6. Put the words in order: the coach / his / team / said / had trained / hard

The coach said his team had trained hard.

7. "We won this championship last year, and we will win it again next year," the captain told the fans. *(The captain told the fans...)* **The captain told the fans (that) they had won that championship the year before, and they would win it again the following year.**

8. Which sentence correctly reports: "I am not playing well this season," the striker admitted.

- a. The striker admitted he is not playing well this season.
- b. The striker admitted he was not playing well that season. ✓
- c. The striker admitted he was not play well that season.
- d. The striker admits he was not playing well this season.

'am not playing' → 'was not playing', and 'this season' → 'that season'.

A Historic Win for the City Team

Before you read

- Look at the title. What do you think happened in the match?
- Have you ever watched a match that ended in a surprising result?

Last Saturday, the City Basketball Team achieved a historic victory in the regional championship final, defeating their long-time rivals by a score of 78 to 74. The match, held at the packed City Sports Hall, kept thousands of supporters on the edge of their seats until the final minute.

After the game, the team captain spoke to reporters. She said she had never felt so proud of her teammates. She explained that the players had trained twice a day for the past month and that their hard work had finally paid off. She also added that the whole team had believed in victory even when they were losing by ten points in the third quarter.

The coach told journalists that the turning point of the match had come when a young substitute player scored three important baskets in a row. He said the young player had shown great courage under pressure and that he was extremely proud of the entire squad. He also mentioned that the team would begin preparing immediately for the national tournament next month.

Fans who attended the match praised both teams for their sportsmanship. One supporter said the atmosphere in the hall had been unforgettable, with both sets of fans cheering loudly throughout the game. Local newspapers described the victory as one of the most exciting sporting moments the city had seen in years, and many are already looking forward to the national tournament.

1. What was the final score of the match?

- a. 74 to 78
- b. 78 to 74 ✓
- c. 80 to 74
- d. 78 to 70

The text says the City Team won 78 to 74.

2. The captain said she had never felt so proud of her teammates. — True / False **(Correct)**

This matches the second paragraph directly.

3. The coach said the turning point came when a young _____ player scored three baskets in a row.
(substitute)

Stated in paragraph 3.

4. According to the text, what will the team do next?

- a. Retire from competition
- b. Change their coach
- c. Prepare for the national tournament ✓
- d. Play a friendly match

The coach said they would begin preparing for the national tournament.

5. Rewrite in reported speech: "The atmosphere in the hall was unforgettable," the supporter said. (*The supporter said...*) **The supporter said (that) the atmosphere in the hall had been unforgettable.**

6. The team had been losing by ten points in the third quarter before the comeback. — *True / False (Correct)*
This is directly stated in the text.

After you read

- Why do you think the captain mentioned the team's training schedule?
- Do you think fair sportsmanship is as important as winning? Why or why not?

Interview: Life of a Young Athlete

Before you read

- What questions would you ask a young professional athlete?
- What do you think is the hardest part of being a professional athlete?

Our school magazine recently interviewed Deniz Aksoy, a nineteen-year-old swimmer who recently qualified for the national team. In the interview, Deniz talked openly about training, sacrifice, and staying motivated.

When asked about her daily routine, Deniz explained that she woke up at five every morning to train before school. She said that balancing school work and swimming was the most difficult part of her life as a student athlete. She added that her family had always supported her, even when she felt like giving up.

The interviewer asked Deniz what advice she would give to young people who wanted to become athletes. She replied that discipline was more important than natural talent, and she said that anyone could improve with consistent practice. She also mentioned that she had failed to qualify for the national team twice before finally succeeding this year.

Deniz told the interviewer that her biggest goal was to represent her country at an international competition. She said she was not afraid of losing, because every competition taught her something new. Finally, she admitted that without the support of her coach and family, she would never have achieved her dream.

The interview ended with Deniz thanking her school for allowing her to combine her studies with intense training, and she encouraged other students to follow their passions, whatever they might be.

1. Deniz said she woke up at _____ every morning to train. **(five)**

Stated in paragraph 2.

2. According to Deniz, what is more important than natural talent?

- a. Money
- b. Discipline ✓
- c. Luck
- d. Equipment

She said discipline was more important than natural talent.

3. Deniz qualified for the national team on her first attempt. — *True / False (Incorrect — She had failed to qualify twice before finally succeeding this year.)*

The text states she failed twice before succeeding.

4. Rewrite in reported speech: "My family has always supported me," Deniz said. (*Deniz said...*) **Deniz said (that) her family had always supported her.**

5. What is Deniz's biggest goal, according to the interview?

- a. To become a coach
- b. To win a scholarship
- c. To represent her country internationally ✓
- d. To change sports

She told the interviewer her biggest goal was to represent her country.

After you read

- What personal quality do you think helped Deniz succeed the most?
- Would you be willing to make similar sacrifices for a goal you care about?

Radio Sports News: Local Derby Result

Before you listen

- What information do you expect to hear in a radio sports news report?
- Predict two facts you might hear about a football match result.

1. Riverside won the match by _____ goals to one. **(two)**

The reporter said Riverside defeated their rivals two goals to one.

2. The Riverside coach said the training on set pieces had paid off. — True / False **(Correct)**

This matches the reporter's second line directly.

3. What did the losing coach admit?

- a. That the referee was unfair
- b. That his team had made too many mistakes in defence ✓
- c. That his best player was injured
- d. That the stadium was too small

He admitted his team had made too many mistakes in defence.

4. Rewrite in reported speech: "It is not serious," the club doctor said. (*The club doctor said...*) **The club doctor said (that) it was not serious.**

Transcript (teacher use)

Presenter Good evening, and welcome to Sports Tonight. Let's start with today's big local derby.

Reporter Thanks. This afternoon, the Riverside Football Club defeated their city rivals two goals to one, in front of a full stadium.

Presenter What did the Riverside coach say after the match?

Reporter He said his players had shown incredible determination, especially in the second half. He also said the team had worked on set pieces all week, and that the training had clearly paid off.

Presenter And what about the losing side? Did their coach comment?

Reporter Yes, he admitted his team had made too many mistakes in defence. He said they would review the match carefully before their next game.

Presenter Any news about injuries?

Reporter The Riverside captain told us that one of the defenders had felt pain in his ankle, but the club doctor said it was not serious.

Presenter Thanks for the update. Now let's move on to tonight's basketball results.

Interview: A Coach Talks About the New Season

Before you listen

- What questions might a journalist ask a coach at the start of a new season?
- What kind of goals do sports teams usually set at the beginning of a season?

1. What did the coach tell the players about the new season?

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- a. It would be the same as last season
 - b. It would be different from last season ✓
 - c. It would be his last season
 - d. It would be shorter than usual

The coach told the players the season would be different.

2. The coach admitted the team's defence had been too weak. — True / False (Correct)

This matches the coach's third answer directly.

3. The coach told the board that the goal was to finish in the top _____. (three)

Directly stated in the last answer.

4. Rewrite in reported speech: "Everyone will need to work harder," the coach explained. (The coach explained...) **The coach explained (that) everyone would need to work harder.**

Transcript (teacher use)

Journalist Coach, thank you for joining us. How do you feel about the new season?

Coach I feel optimistic. I told the players last week that this season would be different from the last one.

Journalist What changes have you made to the team?

Coach We brought in two new players, and I explained to the whole squad that everyone would need to work harder in training.

Journalist Some fans say the team's biggest weakness last year was defence. Do you agree?

Coach Yes, I do. I admitted to the players that our defence had been too weak, and we have spent extra time fixing that problem.

Journalist What is your main goal for this season?

Coach I told the board that our goal was to finish in the top three. I said the players were ready and that they believed in themselves.

Journalist Thank you, coach, and good luck this season.

Revision

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1. "I am training every day," the athlete said. Reported speech:

- a. The athlete said he trains every day.
- b. The athlete said he was training every day. ✓
- c. The athlete said he is training every day.
- d. The athlete says he was training every day.

Present continuous 'am training' back-shifts to 'was training'.

2. Complete: a person who watches and supports a team is called a _____. (supporter / fan)

Vocabulary: supporter/fan.

3. A referee's job is to write sports news articles. — True / False **(Incorrect — A referee's job is to control a match and enforce the rules.)**

A referee controls the match; a journalist writes news articles.

4. Rewrite in reported speech: "We will win the next match," the captain said. (*The captain said...*) **The captain said (that) they would win the next match.**

5. Which sentence uses 'tell' correctly?

- a. She told that she was tired.
- b. She told me that she was tired. ✓
- c. She said me that she was tired.
- d. She told about she was tired.

'Tell' needs a personal object: tell someone (that)...

6. Put the words in order: had won / said / the coach / the match / they

The coach said they had won the match.

7. "I saw the game yesterday," he said. → He said he had seen the game _____. (the day before)

'yesterday' becomes 'the day before' in reported speech.

8. Which word means 'a place where large sports events are held'?

- a. referee
- b. stadium ✓
- c. tournament
- d. commentator

Vocabulary: stadium.

9. In reported speech, 'here' usually changes to 'there'. — True / False **(Correct)**

This is a correct rule of reported speech.

10. Rewrite in reported speech: "My team is playing well this season," the fan said. (*The fan said...*) **The fan said (that) his/her team was playing well that season.**

1. The player broke a rule, so the _____ showed him a yellow card. **(referee)**

Vocabulary: referee.

2. A journalist's job includes...

- a. training athletes
- b. reporting sports news ✓
- c. playing matches
- d. coaching a team

Journalists report news.

3. The team celebrated their _____ after winning the final. **(victory)**

Vocabulary: victory.

1. "I feel proud of my team," the coach said. *(The coach said...)* **The coach said (that) he/she felt proud of his/her team.**

2. "We trained here yesterday," the players said. Reported speech:

- a. The players said they trained here yesterday.
- b. The players said they had trained there the day before. ✓
- c. The players said they train there yesterday.
- d. The players say they had trained here the day before.

trained → had trained; here → there; yesterday → the day before.

3. "I will help the team," she said. → She said she _____ help the team. **(would)**

will → would.

1. In 'A Historic Win for the City Team', who scored three baskets in a row?

- a. The captain
- b. A young substitute player ✓
- c. The coach
- d. A supporter

A young substitute player scored the three baskets.

2. In 'Interview: Life of a Young Athlete', Deniz qualified for the national team on her first try. — *True / False*
(Incorrect — She had failed twice before succeeding.)

The text states she failed twice before finally qualifying.

1. In the radio report, Riverside won by _____ goals to one. **(two)**

Stated by the reporter.

2. In the coach interview, what was the team's main goal for the season?

- ☐ a. Win every match
- ☒ b. Finish in the top three ✓
- ☐ c. Sign new players
- ☐ d. Avoid injuries

The coach said the goal was to finish in the top three.

1. Write one sentence reporting a coach's statement about the team's performance, using 'said that'. (*The coach said...*) **The coach said (that) the team had played well.**